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The Inspector:

If you cannot prove that you were with a friend, we can arrest you.

At the end of the questioning session, Mr.Umar told the inspector the truth.

"Last night, somebody called me, but he wasn't my friend. I had borrowed some money from him and he had given me time till last night to return it. But I did not do so. So, he called home asking me to meet him outside the house. That's why I went out. I did not tell my wife as I did not want her to know about it. When I went out, I saw a stranger entering my neighbour's house but I did not stop as I was in a hurry to meet the moneylender.

Answer the questions after reading the story.

1. Did Mrs. Umar see the thief?
2. What was Mrs. Umar doing when the thief broke into the house?
3. Was Mr. Umar watching movie with his wife when the thief broke in the house?
4. What was Mr. Umar doing in the kitchen?

Frame suitable questions for the following statements.

1. Mr. Umar was at home when the event occurred.
2. Yes, Mr. Umar saw the thief entering the neighbour's house.
3. Mrs. Umar was watching the movie while her husband was drinking water.
4. The thief broke into the house while they were watching a movie.

1. Question Tags

A question tag is a short question added at the end of a statement. It is generally used when asking for agreement or confirmation.

The tag is formed with the auxiliary verb in the statement and the subject. A positive statement takes a negative tag, while a negative statement takes a positive tag. If the sentence contains a main verb, then the question tag uses an apppropriate form of 'do' verb. An appropriate pronoun of the subject is added to the verb to form the tag. The sentence ends with a comma, followed by a tag which ends with a question mark.

Look at the following sentences.

You are a student, aren't you?

Aji is not a lawyer, is she?

Lawrence saw the snake sliding into the hole, didn't he?

Jordi attends the class regularly, doesn't he?

Intonation and Meaning

The intonation (the rise and fall of the voice in speaking) of the tag determines the meaning of the question tag.